

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

1993-07-01

To an individual b ahá'í

1 dear b ahá'í f riend,
2 june 1993 which evinces such devotion to the cause of god. it has asked us
3 to send you the following reply.
4 The house of justice has never gone to the extreme of telling the friends
5 that now is the time to give their long-range savings to the fund. it sets
6 forth the needs of the cause, and calls upon the believers to sacrifice, but
7 the degree and manner of his sacrifice depends on each believer's own faith
8 and good judgment in light of his responsibilities. Again and again in his
9 162-2. Adj, ¶78 (2006).162.9
163 1
163 2
164 1993–1996 • T h e T h r e e Y e a r P l a n
165 51writings bahá'u'lláh emphasizes the need for moderation in all things, and
166 he upholds the importance of using wisdom in all we do and say.
167 devoted believers in every age have found it challenging to decide how
168 much of their worldly wealth they should give to the cause of god, and
169 how much they should use to meet their many responsibilities of life, such
170 as educating their children, preparing for their old age so that they will not
171 be a burden on others, and so forth. you will recall the story of the muslim
who asked muḥammad whether he should tie up his camel or trust in god
that it would not run away. muḥammad's answer was that he should tie
172 up the camel and trust in god! in this dispensation, by the institution of
173 ḥuqúqu'lláh, bahá'u'lláh has provided us with a measure. we are all obliged
174 to pay that portion of our savings that is god's right. what remains there-

175 after is ours to use at our own discretion, for the promotion of the work of the cause
and for helping others less fortunate than ourselves.

176 in the hidden words b ahá'u'lláh revealed:

177 o my Servant! The best of men are they that earn a livelihood by their

calling and spend upon themselves and upon their kindred for the

178 love of god, the lord of all worlds.

179 163-1

180 furthermore, in the twelfth glad-Tidings he stated:

The most despised of men in the sight of god are those who sit

idly and beg. hold ye fast unto the cord of material means, placing

your whole trust in god, the provider of all means. when anyone

181 occupieth himself in a craft or trade, such occupation itself is regarded

in the estimation of god as an act of worship; and this is naught but

a token of his infinite and all-pervasive bounty.163-2

182 Thus to earn a livelihood is a spiritual obligation, and one should not

183 consciously place oneself in a position where one would have to beg others for
material support.

184 it is against this background of responsibility for oneself and one's family

185 that each person must estimate the degree to which he or she can sacrifice

186 163-1. hw , persian, no. 82.

187 163-2. Tb, p. 26.163.3

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163 4a

163 4b

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164 m e S a g e S f r o m T h e u n i v e r S a l h o u S e o f j u S T i c e

165 52for the funds of the faith. The range of options and decisions that the

166 believers can make regarding the management of their personal finances

167 without jeopardizing their future security are great, and can only be evalu-

168 ated by each individual.

169 The house of justice asks us to assure you of its prayers at the Sacred
170 Threshold that you may be assisted with divine guidance and confirmations
171 in all your devoted services on behalf of the faith of Bahá'u'lláh.
172 with loving Bahá'í greetings,

Department of the Secretariat

173 164

Applicability of Bahá'í Laws to Western Believers

[signed: The Universal House of Justice]